PROMPT IT, PREVIEW IT, THEN DEPLOY IT

AIUX experiences, built from VS Code

The AI Experience Lab extension scaffolds a ServiceNow experience on your laptop, runs it against a local dev server, and deploys it to the instance when you are ready. An agent writes the pages and widgets. You never open UI Builder, and you do not log into the instance to see your work.

BEFORE YOU START

- → VS Code **1.97** or later
- → Node.js **24** or later
- → pnpm **10** or later, not npm
- → ServiceNow SDK **4.10** or later
- → Instance on **Zurich Patch 12** or later
- → or **Australia Patch 5** or later

READ THIS BEFORE YOU START

A PDI will not show you the experience yet

AI Experience Lab is not installed on personal developer instances at the time of writing. The tables it needs, `sys_aix_experience`, `sys_aix_page` and `sys_aix_widget`, are simply not there, which is exactly what the screenshot on page 2 is showing. You can still scaffold, prompt, build and run the whole thing locally on the dev server. What you cannot do is deploy it to a PDI and open it on the instance. For that you need an instance where the capability is actually installed.

01 Install the extension

VS Code Marketplace, search AI Experience Lab

Install **ServiceNow AI Experience Lab for VS Code**. A ServiceNow icon appears in the activity bar. That icon is the whole surface: project creation, instance explorer, script runner, quick preview.

02 Prove the toolchain first

Version mismatches fail late and quietly

```
node -v  |  pnpm -v  |  npx now-sdk -v
```

Node 24, pnpm 10, SDK 4.10. If pnpm is missing, `npm i -g pnpm`. The project is a pnpm workspace, so running `npm install` against it is the most common way to break a fresh clone.

03 New project, then pick the instance

ServiceNow icon → + New project

The instance you choose here is where you preview and deploy. If none is connected yet, add one and sign in with the instance URL and the credentials your SDK auth profile uses. Connect the instance before naming anything, the scaffolder reads from it.

04 Location, name, folder, type

Four prompts, in this order

Local path, then experience name, then folder name, then **Standalone App**. Pick Extend Existing App only when you are layering onto an experience that is already deployed on that instance.

05 Application scope

Every PDI uses the same vendor prefix

```
x_1433234_space_fighter
```

Every PDI shares the same vendor prefix, so `x_1433234` is what yours will be too. Keep the prefix, change the part after it to name your app. **Get the scope wrong and you re-scaffold**, it is not a rename.

06 Prompt for the app

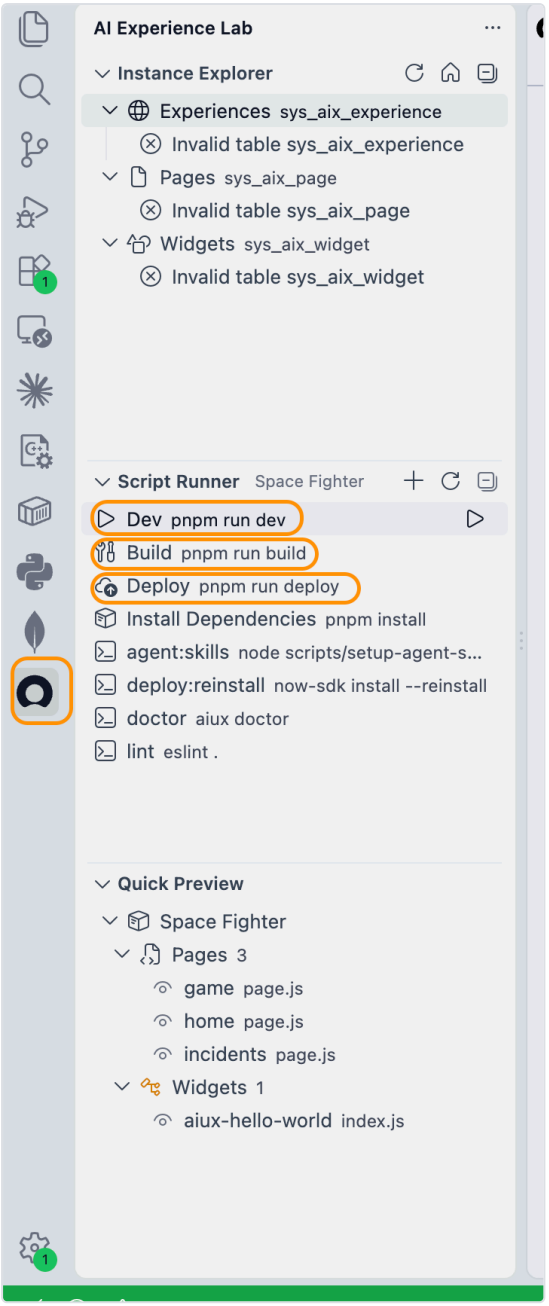
Claude Code, Copilot, or the command palette

The docs treat agentic creation as a first class path, not a shortcut. Point your agent at the scaffolded folder and describe pages and widgets. The manual equivalent is `AIUX: Create Page` from the command palette.

STEP 07 AND 08

Build, run, deploy, preview

Everything below is one click in the extension panel and one command in the terminal. Use whichever you like, they run the same scripts.



EXTENSION PANEL · INSTANCE EXPLORER, SCRIPT RUNNER, QUICK PREVIEW

Dev pnpm run dev

Starts the local dev server and opens the experience in a browser. This is the payoff: your pages render with no instance login and no deploy. Leave it running, edits reload.

Build pnpm run build

Compiles the experience and proves it is valid. Run it after any edit to `application.js`, since navigation changes only show up in Quick Preview once the build has run.

Deploy pnpm run deploy

Pushes to the connected instance. Needed for anything the local server will not render, and for anything a teammate has to see.

Instance Explorer

Reads `sys_aix_experience`, `sys_aix_page` and `sys_aix_widget` off the connected instance. All three read **Invalid table** here because this is a PDI and the capability is not installed on PDIs. Nothing in the project is wrong, and everything below still works.

Quick Preview

The tree of what you actually built, pages and widgets, straight from the scaffolded folders. Fastest way to confirm a page landed where you meant it to.

The rest of the runner

`install dependencies` for a fresh clone, `doctor` when the environment misbehaves, `deploy:reinstall` to force a clean install, `agent:skills` to wire up the agent, `lint` before you commit.

STEP 09

Test the experience without logging in

Leave `pnpm run dev` running and the experience renders locally in your browser. No instance session, no deploy, no waiting on a platform build. Change a page, save, watch it reload. For a first pass at layout, components and navigation this is the whole loop.

The caveat is worth knowing before it costs you an hour: not every page renders on the local server. Anything that leans on instance data or a platform page can only be judged after `pnpm run deploy`. A page that is blank locally is not automatically a broken page.

If it doesn't work

SYMPTOM	CAUSE
Invalid table sys_aix_experience, sys_aix_page, sys_aix_widget	The connected instance does not carry the AIUX tables. On a PDI this is expected, the capability is not installed there. Otherwise the instance is below Zurich Patch 12 or Australia Patch 5, or you are pointed at the wrong one
No ServiceNow icon in the activity bar	VS Code is older than 1.97, or the extension installed but the window was never reloaded
Install breaks on a fresh clone	npm was used on a pnpm 10 workspace. Delete node_modules and run pnpm install
Scope rejected on a PDI	The scope is missing your instance vendor prefix. It has to read x_<your prefix>_<app>
Extend Existing App lists nothing	The experience you want to extend has not been deployed to the instance you are connected to
Deploy succeeds locally but nothing appears on the instance	You are deployed to a PDI. Build and preview locally, and move to an instance with AI Experience Lab installed when you need it on the platform
Page is blank in local preview	Not every page is previewable locally. Deploy and check it on the instance before assuming the page is broken
Page exists but never appears in navigation	It was never registered in application.js with addNavItem, or it was registered and not rebuilt

Two forks, and where the other path goes

FORK 1 · WHERE IT RENDERS

We previewed on the dev server

Local rendering, no instance login, no deploy between edits. This is the fastest loop the platform has right now.

Deploy to the instance instead when a page will not render locally, when you need real data, or when someone else has to look at it. That fork is closed on a PDI until the capability lands there.

FORK 2 · WHAT YOU ARE BUILDING

We chose Standalone App

A net new experience with its own scope, pages and widgets. Nothing on the instance has to exist first.

Extend Existing App instead when you are adding to or overriding a deployed experience. Overrides match on display name and URL route exactly, so a typo silently creates a second page.

DOCS WORTH KEEPING

- → Create a new experience
- → Extend an existing experience
- → ServiceNow SDK on npm
- → Create a page
- → Add a page to the navigation
- → The video this came from

WHERE THIS CAME FROM

AINOW — youtube.com/@aibytusharm

Companion sheet to the **AIUX experiences, built from VS Code** video. The channel runs the full **ServiceNow SDK series**, planning, building and shipping apps with agents on the platform, plus the **Connect X to Claude Code** MCP series. Questions go in the comments.

SCAN → CHANNEL